

 Texas A&M University–Texarkana
GBUS 310 Business Communications
Course Syllabus
Fall 2023

GBUS 310.01 and GBUS 310.02

Instructor: Susan Nash, Ph.D.

Office: online – Teams or Zoom (by appointment)

Office Hours: every day, 9 am – 8 pm Central time, via text or phone

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Phone: (405) 314-7730

Course Number: GBUS 310

Course Title: Business Communications

Course Times: Online

Semester Credit Hours: 3

Course Delivery Method: Web

Course Description:

This course presents communication as a critical component for success in the workplace. In this class, students will develop a foundation for designing effective messages, both written and oral, from concept to delivery. Students will use a strategic communication model to identify objectives, analyze audiences, choose information, and create the most effective arrangement and channel for that message. Particularly, the course emphasizes elements of persuasive communication: how to design messages for diverse and possibly resistant audiences and how to present that information in a credible and convincing way. Students will practice drafting and editing clear, precise, and readable written business documents. Students will develop and deliver an individual presentation, using appropriate and effective visual support, in which they present a persuasive argument that demonstrates relevance and benefits to an audience at different levels of expertise. Students will also learn and practice skills in low structure presentations, managing meetings, dealing with conflict, and leveraging the power of diversity, at both the individual and cultural level.

Text and Materials:

Recommended – I've loaded the content you need in Blackboard:

Business Communications Today 14th Edition or the 15th Edition

By: Courtland L. Bovee & John V. Thill

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Publisher: Pearson

Required:

Title: Financial Literacy

Author: Susan Nash

ISBN #: 978-164496-277-0

Material: 5.5 in. X 8.5 in. Access card

Suggested Retail: \$65

Purchase: <https://www.grlcontent.com/>

Scroll down to “No Access Code? Purchase Access Now” on the lower right-hand corner

Student Learner Outcomes:

Upon successful completion of this class, the student will be able to:

1. Use a strategic communication model and critical thinking to identify objectives, analyze audiences, and choose the most effective structure and style for delivering strategically sound written and spoken messages.
2. Practice principles of effective business writing and document design in all written documents.
3. Design and deliver a persuasive presentation that convinces the audience of the topic’s relevance and overcomes resistance, using appropriate visual support and adhering to a specified time limit.
4. Employ principles of effective group communication to cultivate trust and understanding, increase open participation, and strengthen decision making in work groups and teams.
5. Build an understanding of different organizational cultures, business practices, and social norms to communicate more effectively in domestic and cross-cultural business contexts.
6. Analyze a company’s communication processes or key messages and recommend changes that can help advance communication as an integral part of that organization’s management strategy.

A&M-Texarkana Email Address:

Upon application to Texas A&M University-Texarkana an individual will be assigned an A&M-Texarkana email account. This email account will be used to deliver official university correspondence. Each individual is responsible for information sent and received via the university email account and is expected to check the official A&M- Texarkana email account on a frequent and consistent basis. Faculty and students are required to utilize the university email account when communicating about coursework. This course will not use messaging or email contained in Blackboard, but will use the “ACE” student email system for electronic messages.

Course Etiquette:

All interactions with the instructor and other students are expected to be courteous and respectful.

Library/Media Resources Assessment:

None specified.

Disability Accommodations:

Students with disabilities may request reasonable accommodations through the A&M-Texarkana Disability Services Office by calling 903-223-3062.

Weekly Schedule – Details

1 - Introduction (Discussion 1) - Sept 3

Reading: Chapter 1 – Professional Communication in a Digital, Social, Mobile World

Activity: Discussion 1

2 - Professional Communication - Sept 10

Reading – Chapter 2 – Collaboration, Interpersonal Communication and Business Etiquette

Activity: Reflect on business etiquette and making everyone feel a part of the team

3 - Planning Business Messages (Paper 1) - Sept 17

Reading – Chapter 4 – Planning Business Messages

Activity: Paper 1

4 - Writing Business Messages - Sept 24

Reading – Chapter 5 – Writing Business Messages

Activity: Financial Literacy – Buying or Selling a Car

5 – Revisions – Oct 1

Reading – Chapter 6 – Completing Business Messages

Activity: Financial Literacy

6 - Developing Presentations - Oct 8

Reading – Chapter 7 – Digital Media

Reading – Chapter 16 – Developing Presentations

Activity: Presentation 1

7 - Presentations with Slides and other Visuals - Oct 15

Reading – Chapter 8 – Social Media

Reading – Chapter 17 – Enhancing Presentations with Slides

Activity: Presentation 2

8 - Sharing, Collaborating with Shared Docs for Work (Teams / Google Docs) - Oct 22

Reading – Chapter 9 – Visual Media

Activity: Discussion 2

9 - Communication Challenges in a Diverse, Global Marketplace – Oct 29

Reading – Chapter 3 – Communication Challenges in a Diverse, Global Marketplace

Activity – Discussion 3

10 - Positive and Negative Messages – Nov 5

Reading – Chapters 10 and 11 – Writing Routine and Positive Messages

Activity – Paper 2

11 - Persuasive Messages - Nov 12

Reading – Chapter 12 – Writing Persuasive Messages

Activity 4 – Discussion 4

12 - Resumes - key words / align with job description - Nov 19

Reading – Chapter 18 – Building Careers and Writing Resumes

Activity – Paper 3

13 - Finding job posting / interviewing skills - Nov 26

Reading – Chapter 19 – Applying and Interviewing for Employment

Activity – Discussion 5

14 - Presentation – Dec 3

Reading – Chapter 16 – Developing Presentations for a Social Media Environment

Activity – Presentation 3 (video)

15 - Presentation with audio - Dec 10

Podcasts and long-form Audio

Activity – Presentation 4 (audio)

16 - Discussion board -- what I learned that will help me - Dec 13

Activity – Discussion 6

Means of Evaluation:

Grades will be based on the timely completion of the assignments.

Discussion Board -- 6 posts (50 points each)

Paper 1 – Letter - 100

Paper 2 - Letter - 100

Paper 3 - Resume - 100

Presentation: Step 1 - 50

Presentation: Step 2 - 50

Video: 50

Podcast: 50

Financial Literacy Exercises: 200

Grading Scale:

A => 900-1000 total points

B => 800-899 total points

C => 700-799 total points

D => 600-699 total points

F => 0-599 total points

Class Policies:

① Late work will not be accepted unless with prior approval.

- ① All written assignments should contain the student's name, class title, and the title of the assignment on each document submitted unless a specific structure or template is required in the assignment.
- ① There is no "extra credit" work available in this class.
 - All exams must be taken on the scheduled test dates. Prior approval for a makeup test may be granted for extenuating circumstances. Failure to take all 5 exams will result in the forfeiture of in-class participation points.

Academic Integrity:

Academic honesty is expected of students enrolled in this course. Unauthorized collaboration, falsification of research data, plagiarism, and copying or undocumented use of materials from any source, constitute academic dishonesty, and may be grounds for a grade of "F" in the course and/or disciplinary action. The student is responsible for reading and understanding the University Policy on Academic Integrity.

CBET Program Learning Goals – BBA

- Learning Goal 1: Our graduates will be competent in the broad business disciplines that underlie the BBA degree.
- Learning Goal 2: Critical Thinking/Problem Solving: Upon completion of their degree program, students will be able to demonstrate critical thinking.
- Learning Goal 3: Communication Upon completion of their degree program, students will be able to express ideas clearly and coherently.
- Learning Goal 4: Ethical Dilemmas in a Global Environment: Upon completion of their degree program, students will be able to identify and assess ethical issues in a global environment.

Drop Policy

To drop this course after the census date, a student must complete a [Drop/Withdrawal Request Form](#), located on the University Registrar's webpage or obtained in the Registrar's Office. The student must submit the signed and completed form to the instructor of each course indicated on the form to be dropped for his/her signature.

The signature is not an "approval" to drop, but rather confirmation that the student has discussed the drop/withdrawal with the faculty member. The form must be submitted to the Registrar's office for processing in person, email Registrar@tamut.edu, mail (7101 University Ave., Texarkana, TX 75503) or fax (903-223-3140). Drop/withdraw forms missing any of the required information will not be accepted by the Registrar's Office for processing. It is the student's responsibility to ensure that the form is completed properly before submission. If a student stops participating in class (attending and submitting assignments) but does not complete and submit the drop/withdrawal form, a final grade based on work completed as outlined in the syllabus will be assigned.

Class Participation

Students are responsible for beginning their participation on the FIRST CLASS DAY by logging on and completing assignments according to the COURSE CALENDAR. Failure to submit online

assignments between the first day of classes and the University census date (according to the University schedule) will result in an ADMINISTRATIVE DROP from the course.

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University Requirements: Disruptions, COVID Reporting, and Safety

To address issues related to disruption of university functions, COVID reporting, and safety protocols, TAMUT has prepared a general set of requirements that can be found here:

https://www.tamut.edu/About/Administration/COVID_19/COVID-19_Files/COVID_StudentGuide.pdf

Students with federal loans and/or grants:

Students who have federal loans and grants must be aware that participation is monitored in online courses. In the event a student withdraws from a course the student will be required to refund all federal funds prorated from the last date of participation. A student's last access to Blackboard would not suffice as participation.

Student Technical Assistance:

Solutions to common problems and FAQ's for your web-enhanced and online courses are found on the [Online Student Training](#) page on our website.

If you cannot find your resolution there, you can submit a support request by contacting the IT Service Desk:

Email: isite@tamut.edu

Phone: 903-334-6603

Submit a [Support Request](#)

Additional student help for Blackboard can be found here:

[Blackboard Help for Students](#)

Technical Requirements:

The following are the minimum computer requirements for online learning:

A computer capable of handling streaming video. A mid-range multi-core CPU should be adequate.

A sound card.

A high speed internet connection preferably directly connected to the computer via a hard-wired Ethernet connection rather than wirelessly connected.

Virus and adware protection software.

Microsoft Word, minimum version 2007 or above.

[Mozilla Firefox](#) browser available free.

The most recent versions of Java, Flash, QuickTime, Adobe Reader, and Shockwave. You can check this in the Firefox browser by visiting:

[Firefox Plugin Check Tool](#)

Please note: some instructors may require the use of a headset with microphone and/or a webcam. If so, the cost of these items is not included in your course fees and will need to be acquired at your own expense.

Blackboard Mobile for iOS and Android Devices

Android and iOS devices are currently supported using the Blackboard Mobile App, available for free from your App Store or scan the code below:



The Blackboard Mobile App provides limited access to courses, including the ability to read and contribute to discussions, check grades and announcements, access content, read and comment on blogs, reflect in journals, link to your personal Dropbox, and receive push notifications when courses are updated. Limited course features may also be available via your mobile device's browser; however, your mobile device does not replace your personal computer and should not be used as a substitute for one. High stakes assignments, tests, etc. should be completed on your personal computer, and not on your mobile device.